

Cool queens

LADIES who lorded it

Many queens were overshadowed by their king, but every so often a queen stepped out of the shadows and became a legend.

Hatshepsut

(1508–1458 BCE)

There was nothing average about this **Egyptian oddity**. She married her half-brother, the pharaoh Thutmose II. He died very young, so Hatshepsut declared that she would be the new **PHARAOH**. She dressed as a man and *even wore a false beard*, but, under her almost 22-years as ruler, Egypt flourished.



A scepter is an ornamental rod held by a ruling monarch.

Cleopatra

(69–30 BCE)

This **EGYPTIAN QUEEN** was as deadly as she was **beautiful**. She seduced the Roman general, Julius Caesar, and convinced him to *get rid of the pharaoh*, who was her brother and her husband. Then, she used another Roman, Mark Anthony, to kill her sister.

